Phishing Attack Case Study

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick users into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted source. It usually happens through fake emails, messages, or websites.

A common scenario involves a college student receiving an email that appears to be from their bank or UPI app. The message claims that their account will be blocked unless they verify their details immediately. It includes a link that looks genuine. When the student clicks the link, they are redirected to a fake website that looks identical to the official one. The student enters their login credentials and OTP, thinking it is safe.

Once the attacker gets this information, they quickly access the real account and transfer money or misuse personal data. Students and young users are often targeted because they frequently use online payments and may not verify links carefully.

The consequences of phishing can be serious, including financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts. Victims may also face stress and difficulty recovering their accounts. This highlights the importance of being cautious while clicking links and sharing personal information online.